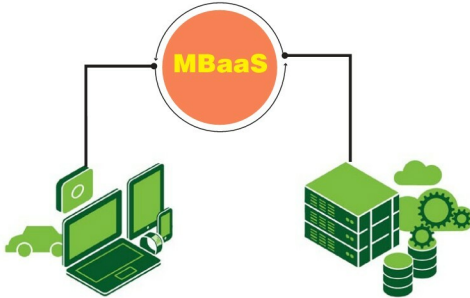


How MBaaS Providers are Simplifying App Development



Mobile app development requires a considerable amount of back-end services to sustain the app. Rather than expend energy and time on the complexities of back-end services, developers would prefer to devote their efforts to developing the apps. Cloud BaaS (Backend as a Service) or MBaaS (Mobile Backend as a Service) providers now come to the rescue.

When we think of software or of Web and mobile app development, two things that come to mind are the server side and the client side. To put it in simple terms, the client side is the front end or interface screen(s) that the end user or client will see and interact with, whereas the server side is broadly a combination of application business logic and data management. With the availability of cloud computing, many of the server side complexities are handled by cloud service providers, as shown in Figure 1.

Software development is now moving towards app development, where the client side development requires more focus due to the variety of devices and platforms in use. This has led to reducing the interaction with servers and a whole new cloud service model has come into being, i.e., the Backend as a Service (BaaS) or Mobile Backend as a Service (MBaaS). This is a unique model, which enables mobile and Web developers to use cloud infrastructure as the back-end, hence freeing them from the headache of back-end designing and integration. It is like infrastructure that can be turned on just for mobile app development. As shown in Figure 2, mobile app development primarily comprises four activities. The major challenges for developers are with back-end integration and most of

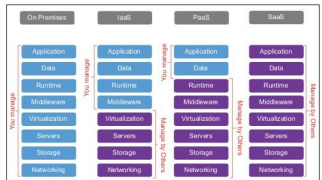


Figure 1: Separation of responsibilities

the effort is focused on this aspect, due to which application design and development suffer. The same applies for Web development also.

Creating a mobile application that works well is a complex and time-consuming task and needs a



Figure 2: Typical tasks in mobile app development